

WEBINAR MASTER SERIES

AI Essentials for Professionals

2. Prompt Engineering & Professional Writing

Developing corporate capability and building judgment without code.

~2 Hours

Duration

Session 2

Today's Content

No Code

Required

Presented by: Master Class Instructor | Duration: ~2 Hours

Lesson Goals

-  **LLMs deep dive:** Understand how LLMs generate text using tokens, and how it can inform the way we prompt.
-  **Master the 7 Cs Framework:** Evaluate and adapt prompt criteria against classic, universally accepted professional communication standards.
-  **Prompt Engineering:** Learn to implement precise boundaries to prevent model hallucination and tone drifts.
-  **Spot Failure & Giveaways:** Recognize automated "AI patterns" and stylistic errors before publishing raw drafts.
-  **Deploy Verification Systems:** Establish a concrete QA checklist for editing and auditing AI-written text

Interactive Engagement

WORD CLOUD

"What writing tasks do you spend the most time on at work?"

[www.menti.com \[5644 1507\]](https://www.menti.com/join/56441507)

[Link](https://www.menti.com/join/56441507)

Interactive Engagement

WORD CLOUD

"What is the most common form of written communication at your job?"

[www.menti.com \[5644 1507\]](https://www.menti.com/join/56441507)

[Link](https://www.menti.com/join/56441507)

AI as Assistant, Not Ghostwriter

The model helps you write, it does not write for you.

- 🛡️ **Retain Liability:** You remain strictly responsible for every single piece of output sent under your name.
- 🔧 **Break Blocks:** Use models strategically to lower initial cognitive resistance and beat writer's block.
- ⚙️ **Co-Pilot Model:** Think of the engine as an editing assistant that drafts structures, never as a silent proxy writer.



The Reality of Daily Communication

2.6H
Avg. Spent on Email Daily

Overloaded Channels

Corporate workers dedicate a vast percentage of their functional workdays processing written material—ranging from transactional emails to workspace instant messages.

Why use AI?

- Save mental labour
- Help overcome writer's block
- Help with striking the right tone for sensitive messages
- Save editing time
- Respond more efficiently

02 How AI Writes

Understanding LLMs, tokens, and context

How Machine Learning Works (Review)

Pattern matching, not understanding

High Level

1

Data Training

Trained on massive public text corpora..

2

Statistical Patterns

Learns statistical patterns—which words and ideas tends to follow others

3

Output Based On Probability

Evaluates input and calculates the statistically most likely next output.



The Autocomplete Analogy

Think of AI as advanced autocomplete.

You type: "The capital of France is..."
Your phone predicts: "Paris."

AI works identically — just at a scale of trillions of words and billions of patterns.



Key Insight

AI has no awareness of when it's wrong.
Confident-sounding output $\neq$ correct output.

How LLMs Works

Demystifying Large Language Models

The Next Level

Input:

1

Tokenization

Splits up text into tokens to find patterns efficiently

2

Embeddings

Converts each token into a vector to determine its “meaning”

3

Transformer

Decides what other tokens to pay attention to, when processing each token to understand the contextual meaning of each token

How LLMs Works

Demystifying Large Language Models

The Next Level

Input:

1

Tokenization

Splits up text into tokens to find patterns efficiently

2

Embeddings

Converts each token into a vector containing coordinates in a meaning space

3

Transformer

Decides what other tokens to pay attention to, when processing each token to understand the contextual meaning of each token

Output:

4

Probabilities

Predicts the next token based on a probability distribution of all possible tokens

5

Sampling

Decides how predictable or variable the next token should be based on its “temperature”

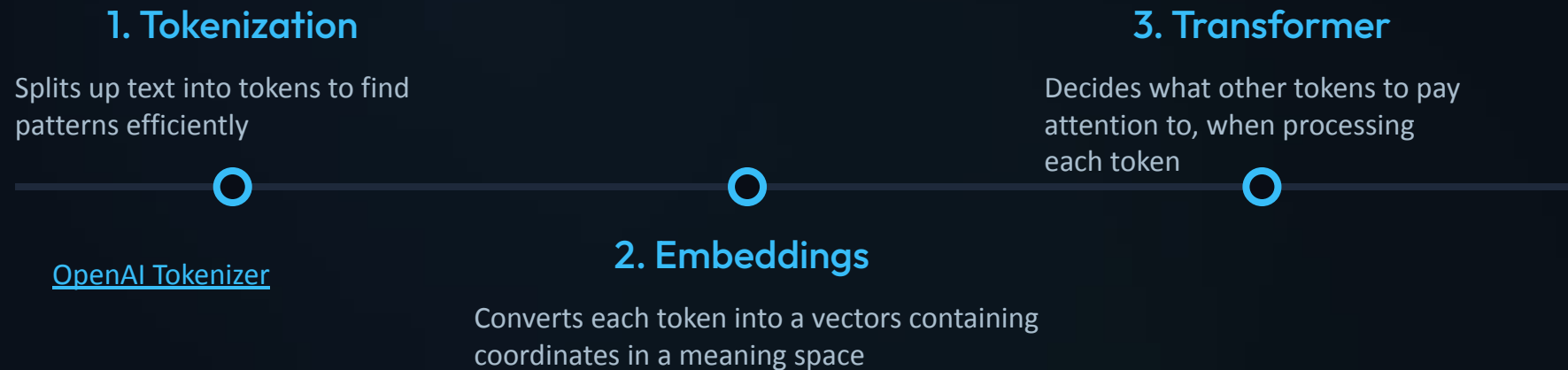
6

Append and Repeat

Appends the newly generated token to the input and repeats the entire process

How LLMs Work Example

INPUT



How LLMs Work Example

OUTPUT

4. Probability

Predicts the next token based on a probability distribution of all possible tokens



6. Append & Repeat

Appends the newly generated token to the input and repeats the entire process



5. Sampling

Decides how predictable or variable the next token should be based on its “temperature”

How We Ask Matters

Key Insights

Token Efficiency:

- AI platforms charge by the token, helpful prompts that constrain output saves money

Transformer:

- Needs enough Keywords/tokens or context to generate helpful output

Probability:

- AI doesn't understand what it is saying. It is making prediction based on the tokens you have provided in your prompt

Sample:

- Context and key details can help set the "temperature" to determine how predictable or variable the output should be

In summary, reducing the amount of **ASSUMPTIONS** AI needs to make

02

Professional AI Writing

Using AI to implement editing professional writing workflows

The 7 Cs of Professional Communication

Clear

Is the message understandable?

Concise

Is it unnecessarily long?

Correct

Is it accurate and truthful? Does it follow the correct formatting?

Concrete

Is it specific enough?

Complete

Is it leaving out any important details?

Courteous

Is it polite and the appropriate tone?

Considerate

Does it consider the specific circumstances of the recipient?

AI is great with:

- Clarity
- Conciseness
- Concreteness
- Courteousness

How AI Can Help

Clarity

- Remove ambiguity
- Simplify long sentences
- Improve structure and grammar

Prompt example:

- *"Improve clarity without changing meaning."*

Conciseness

- Reduce wordiness
- Eliminate repetition
- Convert paragraphs into bullet points

Prompt example:

- *"Reduce length by 30% while preserving key points."*

Tone (Courteousness)

- Make tone more or less formal
- More diplomatic or assertive
- Rewrite for a specific audience

Prompt example:

- *"Adjust tone to be professional and firm but respectful."*
- *"Rewrite as social media copy for general consumers."*

We need to check for:

- Correctness
- Completeness
- Consideration for the recipient

03

Prompt Engineering

Constraints, Techniques, and Pitfalls

Constraint-Based Prompting **Changes**

Content Drift

LLMs are built to predict the next most probable word, which means they can easily **drift away** from your original meaning.

If left unconstrained, models often:

- Adds details
- Assumes context
- Changes meaning

Control What AI Changes

By using constraint-based prompts, you block the AI's tendency to fill in gaps creatively.

Professionals should specify:

- What to change
- What to keep
- What to avoid

Anatomy of a Good Prompt

ROLE

Tell AI who to act like

- This can help determine the voice or tone

CONTEXT

Give it the necessary background information

- Your role and the role of the recipient
- What's the situation

COMMAND

Tell it exactly what you would like it to do

- How you would like to improve your writing
- What are the constraints

FORMAT

What is the format you want the output to be

Good Prompt Demo

-  **Weak Prompt Pattern:** *"Write an email asking for time off"* (Invites hallucinations).
-  **Strong Prompt Pattern:** *"Write a professional email to my manager requesting time off from August 12-19 for a family vacation. I have two team members who can cover my responsibilities while I'm out."*
-  **Stronger Prompt Pattern:** *"Write a professional but warm email to my manager, Sarah, requesting time off from August 12-19 for a family vacation to celebrate my parents' 40th anniversary. I'll wrap up the Q3 report before I leave, and my colleague Jake has agreed to cover urgent requests while I'm out. Keep it concise (under 150 words), and include a line offering to discuss coverage details if needed. Sign off as Alex.."*

Good Prompt Demo

 Draft

Hello Lisa,

I can't make Jerry's retirement party, because I'm going to disneyland.

I also need Aug 20th to the 30th off for a family emergency. I won't be responding to any emails while I'm away.

Bye,

Curtis

-  **Weak Prompt Pattern:** *"Improve this draft email to my supervisor to sound more corporate."* (Invites hallucinations).
-  **Strong Prompt Pattern:** *"Improve readability and professional tone. Keep the main message unchanged. Do not add assumptions, dates, or outside context."*
-  **The Anchor Guardrail:** *"Do not invent policies, reasons, or details. Keep all factual points exactly as written in my original draft."*

AI as an Editor (ACTIVITY)

Demo a bad prompt "Improve this email" then a better one, then an even stronger one.
Participants have to improve an email using constraints to not invent any new details.

Improving a Prompt Demo

Scenario

- You are working as a software developer
- Your co-worker has recently left the company.
- They haven't hired a replacement
- You taken on your ex-coworkers workload and responsibilities
- You are sending an email to your direct supervisor Susan to ask for a pay raise.

Pay Raise Negotiation Prompt

Write me an email asking for a pay raise.

 **Human In The Loop:** *Ensure your improved email doesn't contain any invented details or false information*

Improving Email Draft (Your Turn)

Scenario

- You are working as a software developer
- Your co-worker has recently left the company.
- They haven't hired a replacement
- You taken on your ex-coworkers workload and responsibilities
- You are sending an email to your direct supervisor Susan to ask for a pay raise.

Pay Raise Inquiry Draft

Hello Susan,

I want a salary raise. I've been with the company for five years. Since Trevor left, I have to do more work. He also told me what he makes and I don't think it's fair that I make less. I should be at least making what he made.

How do we make this happen?

Cheers,
Curtis

 **Human In The Loop:** *Ensure your improved email doesn't contain any invented details or false information*

Role Modelling Technique: Role & Context

Demo



Persona Assignment

Instruct the model to adopt a specific communication persona to immediately set its stylistic tone.

Example: Act as a risk-averse legal director or a collaborative team coordinator.



Context Modeling

Explain the dynamic between the sender and recipient to ensure the proper level of professional formality.

Safety Warning: Always strip out private personal information (PII) or internal credentials before prompting public engines.

Formatting Techniques: Zero-Shot vs. Few-Shot

Demo

Zero-Shot Prompting

Querying the model directly without giving it previous structural examples.

When to use: Simple, creative, or standardized instructions where general model behavior suffices (e.g., "Draft a cold sales email for our HR platform").

Few-Shot Prompting

Including one or more exemplary inputs and expected outputs within your query block.

When to use: Complex formatting, strict sentiment classification, or writing copy matching a specific, unique corporate voice.

Framework: Command & Format

Specific Commands

Avoid using ambiguous instructions like *"make this text sound better"*.

Instead, use precise editing instructions (e.g., *"Standardize this raw bulleted list into an official corporate update format."*).

Target Formats

Always specify where the generated content will be sent:

Instruct the model to format the output for email, spreadsheet columns, or brief instant messaging channels.

04

AI Failure Patterns

Common issues from AI writing

Pattern 1: Wrong Assumptions

Invented Conflicts

When asked to polish a neutral message, models might misinterpret standard operational updates as interpersonal conflicts.

The AI may generate overly defensive or apologetic language, implying mistakes where none exist.

Fictional Constraints

Without strict guardrails, an AI might assume deadlines are missed, or reference company guidelines that do not exist.

Always verify that the AI has not added incorrect assumptions to smooth out the writing.

Pattern 2: Tone Mismatches



Over-Softening

Turning firm, necessary operational requests into overly apologetic, vague messages that fail to convey urgency.



Over-Formalizing

Transforming quick, casual team updates into stiff, robotic corporate memos that alienate coworkers.



Diluting Urgency

Softening critical, time-sensitive warnings so much that the recipient misses the importance of the deadline.

Pattern 3: Invented Details

Fictional Justifications - Hallucinations

To make text flow better, models often invent plausible-sounding reasons for decisions (e.g., claiming a delay is due to "system maintenance").

The Operational Hazard: These invented details can easily slip past a quick review and create significant compliance or communication issues with clients.

Timed Run TikTok

Pattern 4: Over-Polishing



- Over-polishing replaces your personal style with generic, overly formatted corporate prose.
- Depending on the context, sending unedited AI writing can be perceived as impersonal
- Always be aware of the context, to ensure your voice is coming through.

Common AI Writing Giveaways:

Punctuation & Patterns

Overusing em-dashes (—) to splice together long thoughts, and constantly organizing lists into groups of three.

Linguistic Shorthand

Using repetitive, artificial phrasing like: *"It's not just about X, it's about Y..."* or *"Delve, testament, beacon."*

Excessive Enthusiasm

Adding overly friendly greeting fluff, emojis, and exclamation points that feel out of place in business communication.

Generic Flow

Starting every section with standard transition phrases that stretch the text without adding real value.

Interactive: Writing Clinic Scenarios

Angry Clients

Subject: Absolutely Furious – Order #48291 – This Is Unacceptable

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to express my extreme frustration and disappointment with your company. This is the THIRD time I am contacting you about Order #48291, and I have yet to receive a single useful response.

I ordered a "SoundWave Pro" bluetooth speaker on May 3rd, paid for expedited 2-day shipping (which cost me an extra \$15, by the way), and it is now May 22nd. Nineteen days later, I still have nothing. Your tracking page has said "label created" this entire time, which tells me the package hasn't even left your warehouse.

I called your customer service line last week and was on hold for 47 minutes before someone picked up, only to tell me they'd "escalate the issue" and someone would call me back within 48 hours. Nobody called. I emailed your support address five days ago and got an auto-reply and nothing since.

This speaker was a birthday gift for my daughter, and her birthday has already passed. The entire purpose of paying extra for fast shipping is now completely pointless.

I want to know exactly what happened to my order, and I want either a full refund (including the shipping charges) or a guarantee that it will arrive within 48 hours. I am also frankly considering disputing this charge with my credit card company if I don't hear back with a real answer by end of day tomorrow.

I've been a loyal customer for over three years and have never had an experience this bad. Please have someone competent contact me directly — not another automated reply.

Sincerely,
Frustrated and Fed Up
Jordan Ellis
Order #48291

Interactive: Spot the Changes

Team Update Draft

Hi everyone,

Just a heads up that the new RTC system will be rolling out next week. Please make sure you've completed all modules before then, as this affects everyone in the department.

Also, don't forget about the change to how we handle trade requests going forward — this should make things a lot smoother for the team.

If you have questions, reach out to Jen.

Thanks,
Neil

Unedited AI Version

"Please accept our apologies as we are experiencing unexpected technical delays regarding the Q3 dataset. To ensure completeness, we will deliver the report on Friday. We appreciate your patience."

Mistake: Invented "technical delays" and removed the direct human query.

Interactive: Spot the Changes



Original Human Draft

"We're running late on the Q3 spreadsheet. The team needs until Friday morning because some data didn't come in on time. Let me know if that works."



Unedited AI Version

"Please accept our apologies as we are experiencing unexpected technical delays regarding the Q3 dataset. To ensure completeness, we will deliver the report on Friday. We appreciate your patience."

Mistake: Invented "technical delays" and removed the direct human query.

04 Guardrails

Proactive techniques to avoid mistakes

Prompting Pitfalls: **Ambiguity & Overload**

Contextual Ambiguity

Using weak qualifiers (e.g., "make this soon", "write a reasonably short brief"). Models struggle with subjective terminology.

Correction: Ground context in quantitative parameters (e.g., "Output exactly 2 paragraphs, limiting each to under 100 words").

Instruction Overloading

Dumping 10 separate complex reasoning requirements into a single monolithic block of prompt text.

Correction: Use systematic spacing, delimiters (like ### or ---), and split multi-layered tasks into chained execution sequences.

The Writing **Verification Checklist**

- ✔ **Verify Names & Details:** Ensure all names, email addresses, and key operational items are accurate and spelled correctly.
- ✔ **Audit Dates & Math:** Double-check all dates, times, and financial calculations. AI is known for making mistakes with arithmetic.
- ✔ **Review Corporate Policy:** Confirm that the text accurately reflects your team's compliance and standard operating procedures.
- ✔ **Check Cultural Fit:** Make sure the final tone is aligned with how your team naturally speaks and works.

Strict Privacy & Security

Protect corporate intellectual property.

-  **No Sensitive Data:** Never share customer databases, employee records, or trade secrets with public LLMs.
-  **Redact Drafts First:** Strip out all private client data, project names, and credentials before using public tools.
-  **Use Corporate Tools:** Only use secure, company-approved enterprise AI instances that keep your data private.



Self-Critique: The QA Prompt

Asking for Feedback

Before using a generated draft, instruct the model to critique its own work to find potential errors.

This simple step forces the model to look for awkward phrasing or incorrect assumptions before you hit send.

Self-Critique Prompt

 **The Self-Audit** "Analyze the text you just generated. Highlight any sentences that could be misinterpreted, any potential tone issues, or any assumptions you made."

04

Anchor Activity

Peer review AI Writing Clinic

Interactive: AI Writing Clinic Scenarios

Choose any two: [Scenario Link](#)



Diplomatic Feedback

Blunt Feedback Notes

Take overly blunt feedback notes and use them to write a diplomatic but direct email.



Improving Resume

Job Applications

Update your resume with new details, improve the formatting and use the new resume to write a cover letter.



Team Announcements

Broadcasting News

Take an email update from your supervisor and turn it into an, engaging, and professional team update.



Efficient Marketing

Repurposing Content

Take the website description of your product and create: social media copy, newsletter email update, and blog post about the release.

Interactive: AI Writing Clinic Scenarios

Choose any two: [Scenario Link](#)



Diplomatic Feedback

Blunt Feedback Notes

Take overly blunt feedback notes and use them to write a diplomatic but direct email.



Empathetic Response

Angry Clients

Write a professional, de-escalating response to an angry client, maintaining firm boundaries while resolving the issue.



Team Announcements

Broadcasting News

Take an email update from your supervisor and turn it into an, engaging, and professional team update.



Efficient Marketing

Repurposing Content

Take the website description of your product and create: social media copy, newsletter email update, and blog post about the release.

Interactive: Writing Clinic Scenarios

Blunt Feedback Email

Website Feedback Notes

- Homepage is a mess, way too much going on, nothing stands out
- font is tiny and ugly, had to zoom in just to read it, who approved this
- orange and green together looks embarrassing, like it was picked at random
- 12 items in the nav menu, nobody's clicking through all that, feels like no one thought about this
- mobile site is broken, text overlapping images, clearly never tested on an actual phone
- checkout took like 6 steps, gave up halfway through, almost didn't finish this feedback either
- no clear call to action anywhere, what am I even supposed to do on this page
- product page took 10 seconds to load, unacceptable in 2026
- stock photos look cheap and generic, feels like a template thrown together in an afternoon
- contact number doesn't even work, disconnected, did anyone check this before launch
- about page still mentions an event from 2019, guess that's just been forgotten
- search is useless, searched "shoes," got zero results, how does that even happen

Interactive: Writing Clinic Scenarios

Broadcasting News

Subject: Q2 Results – For Your Team

Hi team leads,

Wanted to get you the Q2 numbers ahead of the all-hands next week so you can start thinking about how to share with your teams.

Overall it's a good quarter. Revenue came in at \$4.2M, up 18% from Q1 and 12% ahead of target. The Northwind product line was the biggest driver — adoption grew faster than expected after the March update, and we picked up 340 new customer accounts, which is our best quarter for new business in two years.

Customer retention held steady at 94%, so the growth wasn't just new logos replacing churn, which is good to see.

Not everything was great though. Support ticket volume went up 22%, mostly tied to onboarding issues with Northwind, and our average response time slipped from 4 hours to almost 7. Leadership knows this and the support team is hiring two more reps in Q3, plus there's a project kicking off to improve the onboarding docs.

Also worth flagging: the Meridian product line was flat again this quarter, third quarter in a row. There's a review happening on that in August, nothing decided yet.

I'd like each team to share a short update with their group this week — nothing fancy, just the headline numbers and a thank you to the team since a lot of this came down to people going above and beyond, especially support staff who were absorbing a lot of extra volume. Keep it upbeat but don't oversell the support numbers, we want to be straight with people about that.

Let me know if you have questions before you send anything out.

Thanks,
Dana

Interactive: Writing Clinic Scenarios

Repurposing Content

Product Page: FlowState Pro

FlowState Pro — Focus, Organized.

FlowState Pro is a smart productivity app designed for people juggling too many projects and not enough hours. It combines task management, time-blocking, and focus tracking into a single, distraction-free workspace.

Key Features:

- **Smart Time-Blocking** — FlowState Pro automatically arranges your to-do list into a realistic daily schedule based on task priority, estimated duration, and your existing calendar commitments. No more manual planning every morning.
- **Focus Sessions** — Built-in Pomodoro-style focus timers that pause notifications across your connected apps, track your deep work streaks, and give you a weekly focus score.
- **Cross-Platform Sync** — Available on desktop, mobile, and browser extension, with real-time sync so your tasks and schedule update instantly across every device.
- **Team Visibility (New in this release)** — Share a read-only view of your daily schedule with teammates so they know when you're heads-down versus available, without exposing task details you'd rather keep private.
- **Weekly Insights Report** — Every Sunday, FlowState Pro sends a personalized summary showing where your time actually went, which projects ate up the most hours, and how your focus score trended over the week.

Pricing:

- Free plan: core task management and time-blocking for individuals
- Pro plan: \$9/month — adds Focus Sessions, Weekly Insights, and Team Visibility
- Team plan: \$7/user/month — adds shared workspaces and manager dashboards

Availability: FlowState Pro is available now on iOS, Android, and web, with the desktop app (Mac and Windows) launching alongside this release.

Interactive: Peer Review Swap

Partner Quality Review

Swap your draft from the email clinic with a colleague to get real-world feedback on readability.

Review their work using the **7 Cs Framework** to verify that the message is both courteous and highly effective.

The Peer Review Checklist

- ✓ Is the main action item easy to find?
- ✓ Does the tone feel natural and authentic?
- ✓ Did the AI invent any incorrect details?

Choosing the Right Writing Tool



Workspace Tools

Use Gemini integrated directly into Gmail and Google Docs for seamless editing within your existing workflow.



Enterprise Copilot

Access Microsoft Copilot directly in Teams, Outlook, and Word to draft and summarize messages securely.



Native Apps

Leverage system-level AI assistants built into your OS for quick, secure drafting across any desktop application.

Everyday Prompt Templates



Core Master Template



Standard Corporate Prompt "You are assisting with professional communication. Improve clarity and tone. Do not change names, dates, or factual content. Keep the text concise and adjust the tone to be: [Insert Target Tone]."



Custom Style Variants

The Diplomat: Focus on de-escalating tension, highlighting collaboration, and using constructive language.

The Executive: Focus on concise, high-level summaries. Put the key takeaways first and use bullet points for readability.

Everyday Writing Takeaways

"AI dramatically increases drafting speed, but it demands constant oversight. Constraints prevent tone drift, but your voice is what builds real trust."

THE BOTTOM LINE: YOU ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR EVERY MESSAGE YOU SEND.

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